

Japanese Particles Practice

Fill in each blank with the correct particle: は が か に で を から まで

1. I am a student.

わたし _____ がくせい です。

2. There is a cat.

ねこ _____ います。

3. I walk from the station to school.

えき _____ がっこう _____ あるきます。

4. I study at the library.

としょかん _____ べんきょうします。

5. I will go to Kumamoto.

くまもと _____ いきます。

6. I eat sushi.

すし _____ たべます。

7. What is this?

これ _____ なんです _____ ？

8. I came by train.

でんしゃ _____ きました。

9. I like Japanese.

にほんご _____ すきです。

10. I woke up at 8 o'clock.

8 じ _____ おきました。

Japanese Particles Practice

Answer Sheet · は が か に で を から まで

1. I am a student.

わたし は がくせい です。

Particle: は: は marks the topic of the sentence and can be read as "as for me, I am a student." It sets what the sentence is about rather than simply identifying the subject.

2. There is a cat.

ねこ が います。

Particle: が: が marks the grammatical subject and is used with existence verbs (います/あります) and when introducing new information. は would imply the cat is already a known topic.

3. I walk from the station to school.

えき から がっこう まで あるきます。

Particle: から・まで: から marks the starting point ("from"). まで marks the end point ("to / as far as"). They are often, but not always, used as a pair. They can be used to mark the starting point both temporally (i.e. from 7 AM to 5 PM) or physically (from Tokyo to Kyoto)

4. I study at the library.

としょかん で べんきょうします。

Particle: で: で marks the location where an action takes place. Compare: に marks where something exists or a destination. で = "at (doing something)"; に = "at (being somewhere)" or "going to".

5. I will go to Kumamoto.

くまもと に いきます。

Particle: に: に marks direction or destination with movement verbs like いく, くる, かえる. で would be wrong here since で marks where the action happens, not where you are heading.

6. I eat sushi.

すし を たべます。

Particle: を: を marks the direct object, which is the thing being acted upon by the verb. It answers "what?" The verb たべる is transitive, so it needs an object marked by を.

7. What is this?

これ は なんですか か ?

Particle: は・か: は marks the topic ("as for this..."). か at the end of a sentence turns it into a question. It can be thought of as the "question mark" particle and is always sentence-final.

8. I came by train.

でんしゃ で きました。

Particle: で: で marks the means or method by which something is done, which in this case is the mode of transport. This is a different use of で from location, but the same particle. に would be wrong since に does not mark instruments or methods.

9. I like Japanese.

にほんご が すきです。

Particle: が: が marks the object of certain feelings or a state of being like すき, きれい, できる, and ほしい. These verbs behave differently from action verbs and they use が rather than を for their object. は would shift the nuance to "as for Japanese, I like it (but maybe not other things)".

10. I woke up at 8 o'clock.

8じ に おきました。

Particle: に: に marks a specific point in time. It is used with clock times, days, months, and years. Note: に is NOT used with relative time words like きょう, あした, まいにち since those words don't use particles at all.